

## 4.2 Function scope

The origin from where a function can be accessed is called the function scope. A function, once declared, can be accessed from any section of a program. A variable scope will be local to a function, if defined within a function. Use the global key word while using a variable defined in the body part of the program.

Example:

```
function MathSum ( )
{
    global $sum = 4 + 4;
}
$sum = 0
MathSum ( )
print "4 + 4 = ".$sum
```

Here, the global keyword instructs PHP to look for a variable defined outside the function.

## 4.3 Function arguments and return values

In PHP, the codes are passed by both objects and arrays. We have two models to pass data in a program: 'Pass by value' and 'Pass by reference'.

**Pass by value:** This indicates passing the variables. Here the variables are sent as an argument to a defined function. The assignment operator is used to assign it to a different variable. The receiving function or the variable gets a copy of the value of the variable. Look at the codes below:

```
$x=5;
$y=$x;
```

Here, both the variables are assigned the value 5. You can change either of these two variables, but the other one will not be affected. The modification that we insert here, are completely local to the function it belongs to. These changes are not reflected outside the function.

Example:

```
<html>
<head>
<title>Passing an Argument tutorial</title>
</head>
<body>
```